GLASSHOUSE

RAHUL'S ROUGH START

It hasn't been a good start to the year for Congress leader **Rahul Gandhi**. First, R.P.N Singh, once a close friend, crossed over to the BJP. Then, during a recent visit to Punjab, the former Congress president found both Chief Minister Charanjit Singh Channi and party chief Navjot Singh Sidhu wanting to be named the party's chief ministerial candidate for the upcoming poll. Even as Rahul deferred that decision, saying the party would consult its workers, discord brewed in Congress-ruled Chhattisgarh too, with state health minister T.S. Singhdeo saying he was promised the CM's post in rotation with current incumbent Bhupesh Baghel. Troubles, it seems, come in battalions.



Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

Who's That Man?

Kerala chief minister **Pinarayi Vijayan** is seldom seen wearing anything but his distinctive white mundu and half-sleeve shirt. A two-week treatment in the US seems to have led to a makeover, though—the homebound CM was recently spotted during a stopover in Dubai, where he had a series of official engagements and also met his son, who works there. Vijayan was almost unrecognisable in the full-sleeve white shirt and black trousers. Perhaps that was the idea—the state Opposition has been demanding he return to take responsibility for Kerala's worsening Covid-19 crisis.





ANI

Tipple Tattle

Teachers in Bihar were shocked when a January 28 order from the education department, instructing them to spread awareness on the ill effects of alcohol, asked them to also secretly inform the authorities if they found anyone involved in the illegal sale of liquor. However, a day later, education minister **Vijay Choudhary** clarified that such reporting was not mandatory. But still optional, yes?

EARLY BIRD

Although the next Telangana assembly election is due only in November 2023, there are signs CM **K. Chandrashekar Rao** could call for them early. He recently appointed 21 MLAs, three MPs and two MLCs as district presidents, and is set to name his party's state executive committee this month. All this after a five-year hiatus, but still early for the next election, surely?



–Sandeep Unnithan with Anilesh S. Mahajan, Rahul Noronha, Amitabh Srivastava, Amarnath K. Menon and Jeemon Jacob